

the phone got a decent Single Core score of 785 and a Multi Core score of 1962. However, in PCMark Work, the Lava Blaze 2 beat it by a significant margin.

Moving on to GPU benchmarks, the Realme C65 stunned me with its performance. It scored over 1300 points in 3D Mark Wildlife which was more than double the POCO M6 Pro's score. The phone also came out with top-notch scores in all GFXBench tests I ran. The phone can run BGMI and COD: Mobile on Low-Medium graphics with ease but I did notice frame drops after 45 minutes of continuous gaming.

The phone also does well under sustained workload as depicted by the CPU Throttling Test where the phone showed no throttling whatsoever. However, the storage read and write speeds are very low and need to be improved.

As for the UI, the Realme C65 runs Realme UI 5.0 with the latest Android 14 on top. The company has promised two years of software updates and three years of security updates, which is excellent for the price. The bloatware issue continues to persist though. There's third-party apps galore including the likes of Snapchat, Amazon, LinkedIn, Agoda, Netflix, and Public that come preinstalled on the phone.

CAMERAS

The Realme C65 5G has a modest two-camera setup which includes a 50 MP primary sensor and an auxiliary camera. It has an 8 MP front camera for selfies and records video at 1080p at 30 fps on both cameras. The cameras are basic but decent enough for daylight photos.

The primary camera delivers well-exposed images with good levels of detail and contrast. The dynamic range is passable but shadows are a bit too crushed for my liking. Close-up photos look fantastic though with great colour reproduction and sharpness.

One of the best things about the Realme C65's camera is its ability to click unrivalled portrait photos for the price. Portrait photos on the C65 have one of the best skin tone representations I've seen on budget devices. The



level of detail and texture on human skin is also unparalleled. The edge detection is passable but nothing great.

Overall though, the Realme C65's camera exceeds my expectations. It delivers much better results than competitors such as the POCO M6 Pro. My only critique is the subpar low-light photography. In low light, photos come out looking a bit soft and noisy.

BATTERY LIFE

If you're looking for a phone that will dilute your battery drainage woes, the Realme C65 is an excellent option. The phone is equipped with a 5,000 mAh cell. Coupled with the power-efficient Dimensity 6300 6 nm processor, the phone lasts a good two days on light usage. Heavy users will see a respectable screen-on time of six to eight hours, which is excellent.

In our 4K video loop test, the Realme C65 powered through a whopping 15 hours from full charge to empty. 15 minutes of Call of Duty: Mobile only depleted five per cent of battery during my testing, which is great. However, the 15 W charger takes more than two hours to charge to full.

VERDICT

The Realme C65 5G provides exceptional

bang for your buck. At a low price of just ₹10,499, the phone provides smooth performance, class-leading battery life, and impressive photos in daylight. This takes care of the three pillars of a smartphone that most users covet – performance, battery, and camera. Competing phones such as the Lava Blaze 2 and POCO M6 Pro fall short in terms of camera and GPU performance. However, all is not perfect. The Realme C65 – like most budget Realme phones – has excessive bloatware. Additionally, the base variant's 64 GB storage is lacklustre by 2024 standards. Nevertheless, the Realme C65 has made minimal compromises even though it has brought 5G to the masses at a very affordable price point, and therefore, it gets our stamp of approval.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 6300 | GPU: ARM G57 MC2 | RAM: 4/6 GB LPDDR4X | Storage: 64/128 GB UFS 2.2 | OS: Android UI 5.0, Android 14 | Camera: 50 MP + 2 MP | Front camera: 8 MP | Display: 6.67" IPS LCD, 720 x 1604 resolution, 120 Hz | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 15 W Quick Charge | Weight: 190 g | Colours: Feather Green, Glowing Black

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